

Letters & Sounds Teacher-Led Activities are used throughout the progression to introduce key concepts. Topics include grapheme-to-phoneme conversions, decoding / reading, writing / spelling, sound families and affixes. The following activities have been designed for whole class teaching and engagement. They can also be used for smaller intervention groups as required.

These activities are not used as part of the direct teaching component of the daily lesson, but rather, as part of the practice and apply sessions. Their content is consistent with the progression, where all word examples and / or graphemes are familiar in terms of being taught to date. They are used to support and reinforce learning for those children who need multi-sensory support.

The teacher-led activities in Letters & Sounds have been streamlined so that teachers do not need lots of additional resources (such as game boards, sand trays, ping pong balls with letters etc.). Word examples are provided within the teacher notes. The activities are focused and phonics-led (for example, involve children reading a list of words or writing down a selection of letters and words). Teacher-led activities avoid children being distracted by meaningless tasks outside of the phonics scope including: those that create unnecessary workload or cognitive overload, complicated instructions and those with limited involvement or opportunities. Instead, the teacher-led activities included are designed to: build on direct phonics lessons, involve extensive teacher-child interaction, include a multi-sensory approach, follow a routine pattern and most importantly focus on reading and writing with the target grapheme / phoneme of the daily lesson.



GPC Teacher-Led Activities

Hands Up, Pair Up



A quick recall grapheme or word decoding teacher-led activity. The children are given a grapheme card or a decodable word card containing a letter pattern learnt so far. Children walk around the classroom to music. When the music stops the children put their hands up and pair up. The children look at the graphemes, say the corresponding phonemes aloud and then blend to read the word to their partner. They then swap cards and the activity continues more rounds. The teachers focus is to listen to children saying the correct phoneme and then blending to read.



Best Guess

A teacher-led activity for comparing two graphemes. The whiteboard/ IWB or a piece of paper is divided into separate columns (for example 'ch' and 'sh'). The teacher reads a selection of words (4 to 6 words are suggested) and the children need to decide which column the words go into applying the correct grapheme.



Which Phoneme?

A teacher-led activity for comparing two phonemes. Two pictures are displayed on opposite sides of the classroom, each representing a phoneme of interest (for example 'th' voiced and 'th' unvoiced). Children are given a mixture of word cards containing the same graphemes and must decide which phoneme to apply to read the word correctly, and then go to the side of the classroom the card belongs to.

Teacher-Led Activities



Decoding Activities

Lucky Dip

A quick word-decoding activity. The teacher has a collection of words from graphemes previously taught and secretly writes one on a whiteboard. Each child is given a word card that they must decode to read, and then share with a partner. The teacher supports the activity ensuring all children have read their word correctly then reveals the word and the 'lucky dip' winner is the child whose card matches the teacher.



Take Off, Touch Down

A quick word-decoding game. Children sit in a circle and are given cards with decodable words containing a grapheme previously taught. In turn, each child stands up, segments the word (f-or-k) then blends to read the word. The children on the carpet listen and then the child reading reveals the word to the group. All the children can give a thumbs up if agreeing the word has been read correctly, then say the word together. The child with the word card reaches it high in the air (like a rocket) and then sits down as the touchdown. Repeat until all children have had a turn.



Countdown

A quick word-decoding activity. The teacher has a list of decodable words on the whiteboard (including graphemes that have been taught to date) which are covered and the teacher reveals one word at a time. Children must be seen to be segmenting and then blending to read before revealing the next word on the list. A sand timer can be used for fun to complete the list before the time runs out.



Reading Activities

Yes or No

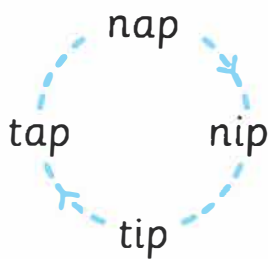
An activity for reading words in sentences. Use prepared questions with yes or no answers, and present on whiteboard or IWB. Children are encouraged to read the sentence in their head (not aloud) or along with the teacher. Children can respond to the sentence by writing yes or no on whiteboards or stick thumbs up or down.

Writing / Spelling Activities



Quickwrite

A quick word-writing activity. Teacher reads out a decodable word (at the children's current level) and the children segment the word by counting the phonemes on their fingers. At an early level, scaffold by writing the first letters on the whiteboard and ask the children to write the last letter on their own.



Full Circle

A quick word-building activity. Involves a list of words (at the children's current level) where an initial, medial or final sound can be manipulated (swapped) to make a new word. Eventually, the original word will be re-created and the children can shout out 'Full Circle!'.



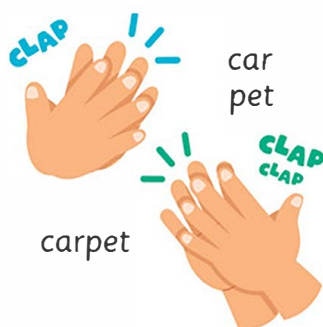
Stash and Flash

A quick word-writing activity. Teacher reads out a decodable word (at the children's current level). The children then write down the spelling on paper or a whiteboard, hide it, then show it together to the teacher.



Write a Sentence / Caption

Share an image of a decodable themed sentence or caption. Suggest a sentence or caption for the children to write themselves. Orally model with the children what they want to write before writing it on the board for them to copy, either on smaller whiteboards or paper.



Clap Syllables

A quick syllables-recognition teacher-led activity. The teacher says a word that contains either one or two syllables so the children can tune in. Begin by modelling one syllable words, then two syllable words. Invite the children to clap with you. Continue with other examples of one and two syllable words where the teacher does not clap and get the children to clap out the sounds.

Vowel Hand Song

a, e, i, o, u a, e, i, o, u a, e, i, o, u (short sounds only)

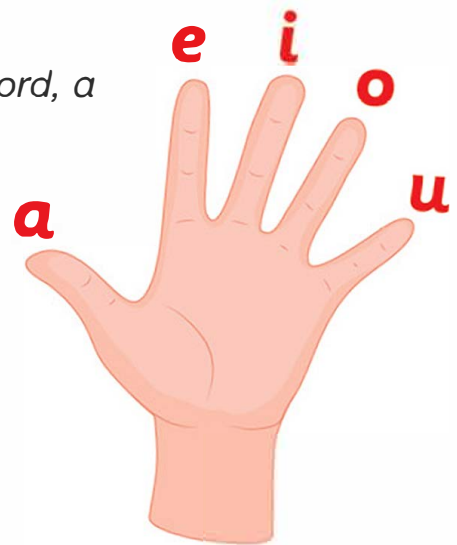
are short vowels that we use

*a vowel is in every word, a vowel is in every word, a
vowel is in every word that we read or write.*

a, e, i, o, u a, e, i, o, u a, e, i, o, u (long sounds only)

are long vowels that we use

*a vowel is in every word, a vowel is in every word, a
vowel is in every word that we read or write.*



Alphabet Song

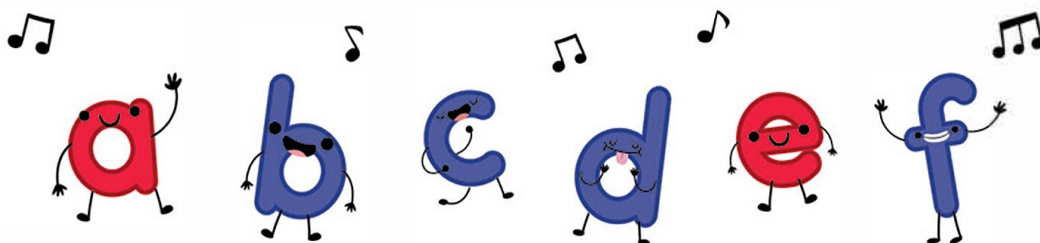
a, b, c, d, e, f, g (all the letters came for tea)

h, i, j, k, l, m, n (the food was quite delicious)

o, p, q, r, s, t, u (oo)

v and w they came too,

x and y ate all the pie and z washed up the dishes.



Decoding and Encoding Mnemonic

The following mnemonics are used to support the understanding and visualisation of the processes of decoding and encoding.

Decoding



look

for the key graphemes



chop

the word by sounding each phoneme



blend

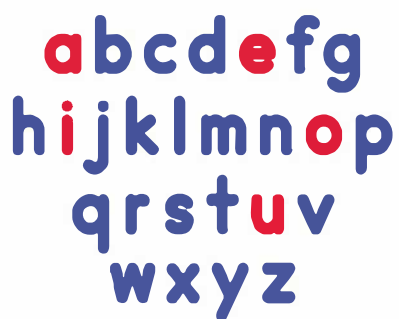
the phonemes to read the word

Encoding



listen

to the phonemes



change

phoneme to grapheme



build

a word